

8.3.3 The Difference Between Services And Processes

Now that you know the number of services running in the background, it is essential to understand why they are not represented under the 'Processes' tab in the Task Manager, which can be activated by pressing [Ctrl] + [Alt] + [Del].



Getting more information on a Service

Ideally, all services running in the background should be represented in the 'Processes' tab. Why they aren't is because the 'Processes' tab only lists the .exe executable for each application currently running under Windows XP. Now applications are responsible for launching services, but they don't represent a single service: that is, an application can have multiple service dependencies. Representing all of them in the 'Processes' tab doesn't make sense.

8.3.4 Services To Stop To Gain Performance

1. Computer Browser

If you have a standalone computer, disable this service completely. If you are connected to a network, but do not use the network for browsing file shares, disabling this service won't affect you.

In addition, disabling this service does not prevent you from accessing file shares on another computer. It's the other user who won't be able to browse your files if this service is turned off on your computer.

2. Messenger

The messenger service is not related to Windows messenger or MSN Messenger. This service allows users to communicate over the net-